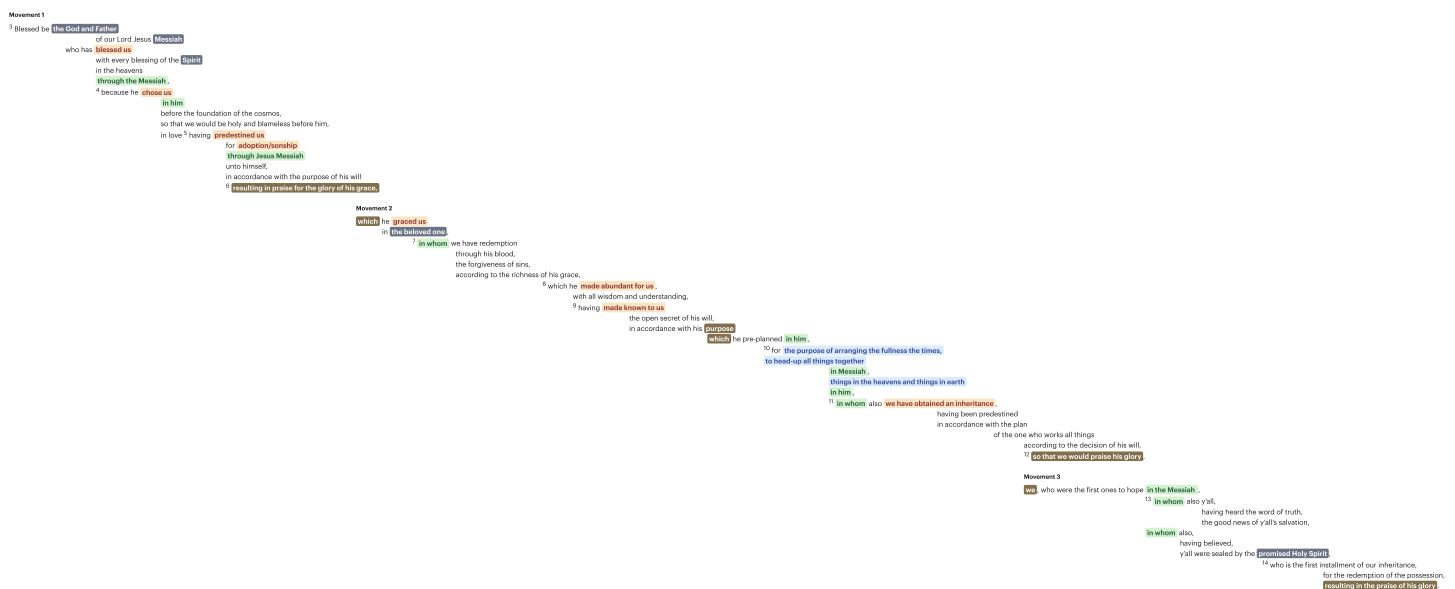


Session 7: Macro Design of Ephesians 1

Key Takeaways

- Ephesians 1:3-14 is one long sentence in Greek, culminating in the central movement in verse 10.
- Verse 10 gives us the core concept and vocabulary that is going to replay in every chapter: All things in Heaven and Earth become one in the Messiah.
- Ephesians 1:3-14 lays out the main theological ideas that Paul is going to explore in the rest of the letter.

A New Song for the New Exodus: Translation and Literary Design of Ephesians 1:3-14



Ephesians 1:3-14. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Ephesians (2019).

Key Themes and Ideas in 1:3-14

The Blessing of 1:3

Paul praises God for the many blessings given to his people. This is a Jewish-style hymn of praise that begins with “blessed be” (Hebrew: *baruk* ברוך / Greek: εὐλογητός) and recounts the story of God’s deeds.

Genesis 14:20 Instructor's Translation

Blessed be the most high God, who gave your enemies into your hands.

Judith 13:17b Instructor's Translation

... Blessed are you, our God who reduces your enemies to nothing on this day.

Psalms 66:20 Instructor's Translation

Blessed be God, who did not set aside my prayer or his mercy from me.

See also [Psalm 28:6-7](#), [31:21](#)

The Spirit-Given Blessings

- Election/chosenness (1:4)
- Adoption as God's children (1:5)
- Grace (1:6)
- Redemption (1:7a)
- Forgiveness of sins (1:7b)
- Knowledge of God's secret purpose (1:9)
- Hope of a future inheritance (1:11-12)
- Presence of God's Spirit (1:13-14)

The Trinitarian Nature of the Blessing

Ephesians 1:3 Instructor's Translation

Blessed be the God and **Father** of our Lord Jesus **Messiah**, who has blessed us in the heavenly realm with every **Spirit**-blessing in the Messiah.

"Spirit-blessing" (Lit. *εὐλογία πνευματικῇ*) does not refer to the nature of the blessing (as spiritual instead of physical), but to the source of the blessing. It is a gift of God's Spirit.

Reflection Question

Ephesians 1:3-14 is one long sentence in Greek. How would you summarize the main idea of this long sentence?